

The Last Lecture

Randy Pauch's last lecture was not at all what I expected going into it. I was immediately struck with how he talked about his own mortality with humor. He didn't go too far into it but gratitude seems to be a core piece of his world view. He spoke with so much gratitude to the people who have helped in his life. I think his attitude is exemplified with the quote "Experience is what you get when you don't get what you want."

I was personally affected by the very end of the lecture. The way he talks about his life and accomplishments almost makes you forget that he was a man facing the end of his life. The reveal that the whole lecture is for his children really struck a chord with me. I looked up his date of death right after. Seeing that it was less than a year struck me. The lecture ended up being uplifting, tragic, dated, and relevant.

I resonated with his concept of head fakes (my wife and I call it Mr. Miyagi-ing). I teach the public, often kids, about video production. Parents love the classes and camps because it teaches them creativity, teamwork, and media literacy skills. These are things I think they care more about than their kid making a stop motion film called *'World War 3: Battle'*. I think whenever we learn a skill we are also reinforcing skills and practices that are very important like how to think critically.

Ultimately I think Randy had the right idea about life and the attitude it takes to live it.